



General Josiah Gorgas

At the start of hostilities, Gorgas was commander of the U.S. Army arsenal at Frankford, near Philadelphia. He resigned to join the Confederates.

The South's advantages

Counterbalancing the North's larger pool of material resources was the Confederacy's immense size. This offered important geographical advantages. The South occupied about the same amount of territory as Western Europe, which gave it what military historians call "strategic depth." This allows an army defending its territory to retreat in the face of a stronger force, obliging the invader to disperse its strength in garrisons and outposts over an ever-increasing area in order to defend vulnerable lines of communication against guerrillas and small detachments of